

ROYAL MANDI HOUSE

DESIGN DOCUMENT

Visual Design & UX Specification — royalmandihouse.in

Project: royalmandihouse.in

Version: 1.0

Date: June 2026

Prepared for: Royal Mandi House, Mangaluru

Status: APPROVED FOR DEVELOPMENT

1. Design Philosophy

Royal Mandi House targets the premium Arabic dining segment in Mangaluru. The visual identity must communicate luxury, authenticity, and warmth — drawing on the opulence of Gulf Arabic hospitality while remaining grounded and approachable for a Mangaluru audience.

The design language is cinematic and editorial: deep blacks that evoke a fine dining atmosphere, gold that references royalty and Arabic craftsmanship, and careful typography that balances elegance with readability. Every design decision is made to create appetite — visually, the website should make you hungry before you've read a single word.

The single most important design principle: the website must work and feel premium on a mid-range Android phone on 4G. Everything else is secondary.

2. Color System

2.1 Primary Palette

Name	Hex Code	RGB	Usage
Royal Gold	#D4A017	212, 160, 23	Primary accent — buttons, borders, highlights, stars
Gold Light	#E8B84B	232, 184, 75	Hover states on gold elements
Gold Dark	#A67C00	166, 124, 0	Active/pressed states
Deep Black	#0A0A0A	10, 10, 10	Primary page background
Card Black	#111111	17, 17, 17	Card backgrounds, navbar background
Section Dark	#161616	22, 22, 22	Alternate section backgrounds
Pure White	#FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	Primary text on dark backgrounds
Muted White	#CCCCCC	204, 204, 204	Secondary text, captions, meta
Subtle Gray	#888888	136, 136, 136	Placeholder text, disabled states

2.2 Semantic Colors

Purpose	Color	Hex
Success / Halal badge	Green	#22C55E

Purpose	Color	Hex
Error / Alert	Red	#EF4444
Star ratings	Gold	#D4A017
Link hover	Gold Light	#E8B84B
Overlay on images	Black alpha 55%	rgba(0,0,0,0.55)

2.3 Color Rules

- NEVER use pure white (#FFFFFF) as a background — always deep black (#0A0A0A) or card black (#111111)
- NEVER add a second accent color — gold is the only accent, used consistently everywhere
- Text on dark backgrounds: #FFFFFF primary, #CCCCCC secondary, #888888 tertiary
- Gold must always be the same hex (#D4A017) — not #FFD700 (too yellow/cheap) not #FFC107 (Material Yellow)
- Image overlays always rgba(0,0,0,0.55) — darker than this loses the food photo, lighter than this loses text readability

3. Typography

3.1 Typefaces

Role	Typeface	Google Fonts URL	Weights
Display / Headings	Playfair Display	fonts.google.com/specimen/Playfair+Display	400, 700
Body / UI	Inter	fonts.google.com/specimen/Inter	400, 500, 600
Fallback (Headings)	Georgia, serif	System font	N/A
Fallback (Body)	Arial, sans-serif	System font	N/A

3.2 Type Scale

Element	Font	Size (Desktop)	Size (Mobile)	Weight	Color
Hero Headline	Playfair Display	72px / 4.5rem	36px / 2.25rem	700	#FFFFFF

Element	Font	Size (Desktop)	Size (Mobile)	Weight	Color
Hero Subheadline	Inter	20px / 1.25rem	16px / 1rem	400	#CCCCCC
Hero Eyebrow	Inter	13px / 0.8rem	12px / 0.75rem	600 + letter-spacing 0.2em	#D4A017
H1 — Section Title	Playfair Display	48px / 3rem	32px / 2rem	700	#FFFFFF
H2 — Subsection	Playfair Display	32px / 2rem	24px / 1.5rem	700	#FFFFFF
H3 — Card Title	Inter	20px / 1.25rem	18px / 1.125rem	600	#FFFFFF
Body Text	Inter	16px / 1rem	15px / 0.94rem	400	#CCCCCC
Menu Item Name	Inter	16px / 1rem	15px / 0.94rem	500	#FFFFFF
Menu Item Price	Inter	16px / 1rem	15px / 0.94rem	600	#D4A017
Button Text	Inter	15px / 0.94rem	14px / 0.875rem	600 + letter-spacing 0.05em	Depends
Nav Links	Inter	15px / 0.94rem	14px / 0.875rem	500	#CCCCCC
Caption / Meta	Inter	13px / 0.8rem	12px / 0.75rem	400	#888888

3.3 Typography Rules

- Playfair Display for all emotional, brand-facing headings
- Inter for all functional, navigational, and data text
- NEVER use a third typeface
- Line height: 1.6 for body text, 1.2 for headings
- Letter spacing: 0.2em on all-caps eyebrow text, 0 elsewhere
- Section titles centered on mobile, can be left-aligned on desktop
- Maximum line length: 65 characters for body text — prevents too-wide lines on desktop

4. Component Design Specs

4.1 Navigation Bar

State	Height	Background	Logo Size	Padding
Default (top of page)	80px	rgba(0,0,0,0.95)	48px height	0 40px
Scrolled (after 80px)	60px	rgba(0,0,0,0.98) + blur(10px)	38px height	0 40px
Mobile	60px	rgba(0,0,0,0.98)	38px height	0 20px

- Border bottom: 1px solid rgba(212,160,23,0.3) — subtle gold line
- Nav link hover: color transitions to #D4A017 in 200ms
- Active nav link: color #D4A017, no other decoration
- Call Now button: gold border, gold text, hover fills with gold and text goes black

4.2 Buttons

Variant	Background	Text Color	Border	Hover State
Primary (solid)	#D4A017	#000000	none	background #E8B84B, lift translateY(-2px)
Secondary (outline)	transparent	#D4A017	2px solid #D4A017	background fills gold, text goes black
Ghost	transparent	#FFFFFF	1px solid rgba(255,255,255,0.3)	border turns gold, text turns gold

- All buttons: border-radius 4px, padding 14px 32px, font Inter 600, letter-spacing 0.05em
- Minimum touch target on mobile: 44px height
- Transition: all 0.3s ease on all button states

4.3 Menu Category Cards

- Size: ~280px x 200px (desktop), full-width x 160px (mobile)
- Background: food photo with dark overlay rgba(0,0,0,0.4)
- Category name: Inter 600, 20px, white, centered, positioned bottom-center
- Border: 1px solid rgba(212,160,23,0.2)
- Border radius: 8px
- Hover: overlay lightens to rgba(0,0,0,0.2), image scales to 1.05x, gold border brightens
- Transition: all 0.4s ease

4.4 Full Menu Tabs

- Tab bar: horizontal scroll on mobile (overflow-x: auto, scrollbar hidden)
- Tab item: Inter 500, 15px, padding 12px 20px, color #888888
- Active tab: color #D4A017, gold underline 2px
- Gold underline animates position with CSS transition 300ms ease
- Tab panel: list of rows, each row flexbox space-between
- Item name: Inter 500, 16px, #FFFFFF
- Item price: Inter 600, 16px, #D4A017
- Row separator: 1px solid rgba(255,255,255,0.05)

4.5 Review Cards

Element	Specification
Card background	#111111
Card border	1px solid rgba(212,160,23,0.2)
Card border radius	12px
Card padding	28px
Reviewer name	Inter 600, 16px, #FFFFFF
Review text	Inter 400, 15px, #CCCCCC, line-height 1.7
Stars	Font Awesome fa-star, 16px, #D4A017
Avatar circle	40px, background #D4A017 20% opacity, initials in gold

4.6 Blog Cards

- Card: dark background #111111, border 1px solid rgba(212,160,23,0.15), border-radius 12px
- Image: 240px height, object-fit cover, border-radius top corners only
- Content padding: 20px
- Category tag: Inter 600, 11px, gold color, letter-spacing 0.15em, all-caps
- Title: Playfair Display 700, 20px, white, line-height 1.4
- Excerpt: Inter 400, 14px, #888888, 3-line clamp
- Read More: Inter 600, 14px, gold color, arrow icon, underline on hover
- Hover: card lifts 4px (translateY -4px), border brightens

5. Section-by-Section Layout Specs

5.1 Hero Section

- Height: 100vh (full viewport height)
- Background: absolute positioned images, z-index 0, width 100%, height 100%, object-fit cover
- Overlay: absolute, z-index 1, background rgba(0,0,0,0.55), full coverage
- Content: absolute, z-index 2, centered (flexbox column align-center justify-center)
- Logo: 120px height, auto width, margin-bottom 24px
- Eyebrow: Inter 600, 12px, gold, letter-spacing 0.3em, uppercase, margin-bottom 16px
- Headline: Playfair Display 700, 72px desktop / 36px mobile, white, text-align center
- Subheadline: Inter 400, 20px desktop / 16px mobile, #CCCCCC, text-align center, max-width 600px
- Button group: flex row gap 16px, margin-top 32px
- Slide dots: position absolute bottom 32px, flex row gap 8px, each dot 8px circle gold

5.2 About Section

- Background: #111111
- Desktop: 2-column grid, 1fr 1fr, gap 60px, align-items center
- Mobile: single column, image above text
- Text column: eyebrow, H2, body text, 4 bullet points with gold checkmark icons
- Image column: food photo, border-radius 12px, border 2px solid rgba(212,160,23,0.3)
- Halal badge: green circular badge, positioned bottom-left of image

5.3 Spotlight Section (Honey Chilly Chicken)

- Height: 500px desktop, 350px mobile
- Background: the Honey Chilly photo, fixed attachment (parallax), center center, cover
- Overlay: rgba(0,0,0,0.6)
- Content: centered, max-width 700px
- 'SIGNATURE DISH' eyebrow: gold, 12px, letter-spacing 0.3em
- Headline: Playfair Display 700, 56px desktop / 32px mobile, white
- Subtext: 'Royal Mandi House — Hampankatta, Mangaluru', Inter 400, 18px, #CCCCCC

5.4 Gallery Section

- Background: #0A0A0A
- Grid: 3 columns desktop, 2 columns tablet, 1 column mobile, gap 12px
- Some images span 2 rows (masonry effect) using grid-row: span 2
- Image container: overflow hidden, border-radius 8px
- Hover overlay: rgba(0,0,0,0.5) fade-in, magnifier icon centered

- Lightbox: full-screen overlay, image centered, X button top-right, prev/next arrows

5.5 Contact Section

- Background: #111111
- 2-column grid desktop: map left (60% width), contact info right (40% width)
- Google Maps iframe: height 400px, border-radius 12px, border 1px solid rgba(212,160,23,0.3)
- Contact info: stacked items with gold icons — location pin, phone, clock
- Phone number: larger size (24px), gold color, bold, clickable
- Hours badge: 'Open Today 12PM – 12AM' in green
- Halal badge: green circle with Halal text

6. Logo Usage

Placement	Size	Position	Background
Navbar (default)	48px height, auto width	Left side, vertically centered	Transparent (navbar is dark)
Navbar (scrolled)	38px height, auto width	Left side, vertically centered	Transparent
Hero section	120px height, auto width	Center, above headline	Transparent on image+overlay
Footer	80px height, auto width	Center	Transparent on dark bg
Mobile navbar	40px height, auto width	Left side	Transparent

- Logo must NEVER be placed on a white or light background
- Logo must NEVER be resized below 38px height (unreadable)
- Logo must NEVER be recolored — use original gold on black version only
- Minimum clear space around logo: 12px on all sides

7. Mobile UX Specifications

7.1 Mobile Navigation

- Hamburger icon: 3 horizontal lines, 24px, gold color, top-right of navbar
- Menu opens: slides in from right, full-screen overlay, dark background
- Menu items: stacked vertically, 56px height each, Inter 500, 18px, white
- Active item: gold color
- Close button: X icon top-right of menu overlay
- Opening/closing: 0.3s ease transform translateX

7.2 Mobile Touch Targets

Element	Minimum Size	Note
All buttons	44px height	Thumb-reachable minimum
Nav menu items	56px height	Easy tap in mobile menu
Menu tabs	44px height	Scrollable row, each tab 44px+
Gallery images	100px x 100px	Easy to tap to open lightbox
Phone number link	44px height	Critical — direct call
Hamburger icon	44px x 44px	Tap area, icon is 24px inside

7.3 Mobile Layout Adjustments

- Hero headline: 36px (down from 72px desktop)
- Section padding: 50px 0 (down from 80px 0 desktop)
- Container padding: 0 20px (prevents edge-to-edge content)
- Menu category grid: 2 columns (down from 4)
- Reviews: single column stack (down from 3 columns)
- Blog: single column stack (down from 3 columns)
- Contact: map on top, info below (stacked)
- Spotlight headline: 32px (down from 56px)

8. Accessibility

Requirement	Implementation
Color contrast ratio	All text meets WCAG AA (4.5:1 minimum). White on black = 21:1. Gold on black = 7.5:1

Requirement	Implementation
Focus indicators	Visible gold outline (2px) on all focusable elements
Alt text	All images have descriptive alt attributes
ARIA labels	Hamburger button: aria-label='Open menu'. Lightbox close: aria-label='Close'
Keyboard nav	All interactive elements reachable via Tab key
Skip link	Visually hidden 'Skip to main content' link as first element
Heading hierarchy	H1 → H2 → H3, never skipped
Reduced motion	@media prefers-reduced-motion disables all animations

9. DO / DON'T Reference

Category	DO	DON'T
Colors	Use #D4A017 gold consistently	Use #FFD700 or #FFC107 — looks cheap
Colors	Keep background deep black #0A0A0A	Use pure white backgrounds anywhere
Colors	Add only gold as accent color	Add red, blue, green as accent colors
Typography	Use Playfair Display for headings	Mix a third typeface
Typography	Keep body text minimum 15px	Use text smaller than 14px on mobile
Images	Use dark moody food photography	Use bright white studio food shots
Images	Compress images below 200KB	Upload full-size JPEG (2MB+)
Spacing	Add 80px section padding desktop	Crowd sections together
Animations	Keep animations under 400ms	Use slow (800ms+) animations on hover
Animations	Use IntersectionObserver for scroll	Poll scroll event for animations
Mobile	Design for 320px min width first	Design desktop first
SEO	One H1 per page with location keyword	Use multiple H1 tags
Logo	Show logo in navbar, hero, footer	Show logo on every section card

